

new fonts' option. What should I do?

Nehal Mehta

A Getting the 'Install new fonts' option back into the File menu will be tricky. You need to boot the machine in MS-DOS mode, and go to the Windows\System folder. Here, find the Fontext.dll file, and rename it to Fontext.old. Extract the Fontext.dll file from the Windows 98 installation CD to the same folder. Now, restart the PC and check whether the problem is solved. If it isn't, your desktop.ini file is damaged. Restart the PC in MS-DOS mode again, and go to the Windows\Fonts folder. If Desktop.ini exists, rename it to Desktop.old, and extract a new copy from the Windows 98 CD. You can see the steps involved in extracting compressed files from the installation CD at <http://support.microsoft.com/default.aspx?scid=kb;EN-US;129605#5>.

Illustrations: Mahesh Benkar



Sibling fight

Q I have a Pentium 4 1.6 GHz CPU on an Intel D845WN motherboard, 512 MB RAM, a 40 GB hard disk with three partitions, an nVidia Riva TNT2 64 display card and a Creative SoundBlaster Live 5.1 audio card, running Windows 98SE. Recently, I installed Windows XP Professional with a dual-boot option. Surprisingly, the default installation options installed it on my C: drive, which also has Windows 98. Both worked fine for a while, allowing me to choose an OS while booting.

Now, all of a sudden, I can't boot into Windows XP. After the XP loading screen appears, the PC reboots. Should I reload Windows XP? Can dual operating systems be installed on the same partition?

Rajiv Raje

A You have to use the Repair function from the Windows XP CD. You are likely to face the same problems again though, as both Windows 98 and Windows XP share the same Program Files folder. We suggest you install both OSes on different partitions.

BIOS upsets

Q I upgraded from a Pentium III 700 MHz to Pentium III 1.2 GHz, but when my system rebooted, it asked for the BIOS setup. I mistakenly entered the processor clock as Pentium III 1000. Now my system hangs whenever I power it on—I

can't even press delete to enter the BIOS setup.

My technician says I need to upgrade the Intel 810 motherboard since it doesn't support the new processor. Is there any other solution?

Arvind Verma

A Yes, it is true that the Intel 810 motherboard does not support the Pentium III 1.2 GHz CPU. This processor is a Tualatin core-based processor (1.475V), with the same pin count (370-pins). Hence, though this processor fits into your motherboard, it will not function. You have to upgrade your motherboard to a D812EEA2 chipset-based motherboard.

Driving off track

Q I bought a Gainward Ultra/860 LE Powerpack that has an nVidia GeForce FX5700LE chipset. I installed this video card along with the necessary drivers, but the display went blank after the mandatory reboot. On reverting to my onboard graphics, I got an error message saying, "The driver for the display device was unable to complete a drawing operation. Please check with the device manufacturer for a driver update."

I downloaded the latest drivers from nVidia, but the problem persists. My PC runs Windows XP Professional, and has an AMD Athlon XP 2000+ CPU and 512 MB DDR RAM on an ASUS A7N266VM motherboard with the nForce chipset. The motherboard also supports onboard sound. Please help.

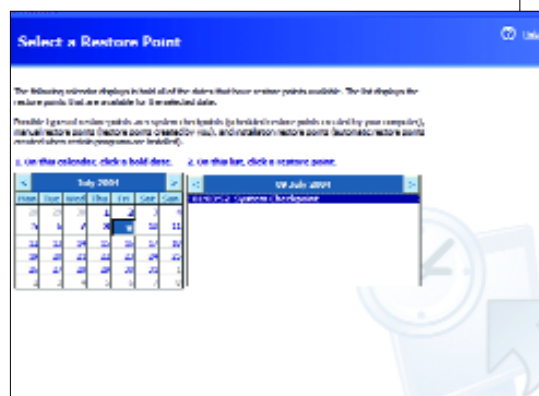
Sandeep Pillay

A A device driver conflict seems to be at play. Here's what you can do: Boot your system

from the onboard video card, and then uninstall all the video card drivers. If possible, use System Restore to get back to a time when the computer was working fine, and then uninstall the display drivers.

Now, reboot your computer and go into the BIOS. Go to the Advanced Options, and look for the PCI display menu. Under VGA BIOS, change the adapter to AGP VGA. Save the settings, shut down the computer, and install the new video card. Reboot and install the display drivers. Your issue should be resolved.

Alternatively, start the machine in Safe Mode. Right-click on My Computer and select Properties. Go to Hardware > Device Manager and expand the Display adapters option. Right-click on each entry under display adapters, and select uninstall. It is imperative that you install only the latest drivers for the motherboard, and also ensure that your BIOS is up to date.



Roll back your system to a healthy state using System Restore